

Respect Yourself and Others: Introduction Featuring Teela Jackson

Coach Pat Summitt

Sometimes I ask myself, 'Could I play for me?' The answer is not always yes.

Back in 1974, I was a 22-year-old head coach, and I had four players who were 21. I was hard on them and myself and everyone around me. I thought I had to be. I thought that's how you commanded respect. My first day on the job I stood in front of a packed room of Tennessee undergrads who came to open tryouts for the team. I decided I was going to set the tone right then and there. I was going to let everyone know how *in charge* I was.

I gave a long speech about how demanding it would be to play for the Lady Volunteers. Well, after that meeting at least 30 kids never came back. The opening day of practice was pretty funny, too. I worked those prospects up and down the court at full speed for two solid hours.

At the end of that, I ordered them to run a bunch of conditioning drills. I ran them in 'suicide drill' after 'suicide drill.' A group of four young ladies were running together. When they got to the end of the line they just kept on running. They ran out the door and up the steps and I never saw them again.

My ideas about how to command respect have changed since then. I've learned you can't demand it or whack it out of people with a two-by-four. You have to cultivate it, in yourself and those around you.

Teela Jackson, Vice President, HR

Over the years, Pat Summitt recognized that she could not simply demand respect from her players. She had to earn it, just as they had to earn her respect and the respect of their peers.

As we dive into Pat's Definite Dozen principle, *Respect Yourself and Others*, you will see how Pat's philosophy about respect evolved over time, and how Pat emphasized trust and respect to build championship-winning teams.

In addition, we will examine how to use peer-to-peer accountability for achieving results as well as ways in which we can demonstrate respect for ourselves and behaviors that might undermine the respect we hope to gain from our teammates. So, buckle up, and enjoy the ride while you respect yourself and others.